The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

3rd February 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Bolster (मजबूत करना)

Meaning: To support, strengthen, or reinforce.
Synonyms: Support, reinforce, strengthen
Antonyms: Weaken, undermine, diminish
Example: The government has introduced new policies to bolster economic growth.

2. Virtuous Cycle (सद्गुणी चक्र)

Meaning: A positive feedback loop where beneficial results reinforce each other.
Synonyms: Positive loop, self-sustaining growth, beneficial cycle
Antonyms: downward spiral, negative loop
Example: Increased employment leads to higher consumer spending, creating a virtuous cycle of economic growth.

VOCABULARY

3. Catalyse (प्रेरित करना)

Meaning: To cause or accelerate a process.
Synonyms: Accelerate, trigger, stimulate
Antonyms: Hinder, obstruct, delay
Example: The new infrastructure projects will catalyse economic development in rural areas.

4. Consonance (अनुरूपता/सामंजस्य)

Meaning: Agreement or harmony between different things.
Synonyms: Harmony, accord, coherence
Antonyms: Dissonance, conflict, discord
Example: The Budget's focus on employment is in consonance with the government's long-term economic goals.

VOCABULARY

5. Sine Qua Non (अनिवार्य शर्त)

Meaning: An essential condition or prerequisite.
Synonyms: Essential element, necessity, prerequisite
Antonyms: Non-essential, optional, superfluous
Example: A stable economy is a sine qua non for sustainable development.

6. Bumps (रुकावटें)

Meaning: Obstacles or setbacks.
Synonyms: Obstacles, hurdles, setbacks
Antonyms: Advantages, boosts, advancements
Example: Despite a few bumps along the way, the project was completed on time.

VOCABULARY

7. Demoting (हटाना)

Meaning: To reduce to a lower rank or grade.
Synonyms: Downgrading, declassifying, reassigning
Antonyms: Promoting, elevating, advancing
Example: Due to his repeated mistakes, he was demoted from manager to assistant.

8. Acrimonious (तीखा, कटु)

Meaning: Angry and bitter, especially in speech or debate.
Synonyms: Hostile, bitter, harsh
Antonyms: Amicable, friendly, mild
Example: The debate turned acrimonious as the candidates began attacking each other's past decisions.

VOCABULARY

9. Skeptical (संदिग्ध)

Meaning: Doubtful or uncertain about something.
Synonyms: Doubtful, dubious, cynical
Antonyms: Trusting, confident, assured
Example: Despite the promises, she remained skeptical about the new policy's effectiveness.

10. Revamp (सुधारना, पुनराविष्कार)

Meaning: To improve or renovate something, especially to make it more modern or effective.
Synonyms: Overhaul, renovate, update
Antonyms: Neglect, ignore, deteriorate
Example: The company decided to revamp its marketing strategy to better reach its target audience.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Chime in
Meaning – To join or interrupt a conversation with a comment.

2. Cop out
Meaning – To avoid responsibility or commitment in a weak or cowardly way.

3. Duff up
Meaning – To beat or physically attack someone.

4. Fence in
Meaning – To restrict or confine someone or something.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Fair-weather friend

Meaning – Someone who is only a friend in good times but abandons you in difficult situations.

2. Food for thought

Meaning – Something that makes you think deeply or consider carefully.

3. In ages

Meaning – For a very long time.

VOCABULARY

4. Scare the living daylights out of

Meaning – To frighten someone very badly.

5. A bone to pick

Meaning – A disagreement or issue that needs to be discussed or resolved.

Article for Reading

A Budget that is forward-looking and growth-oriented

The Union Budget 2025-26 is in line with the government's sustained efforts over the past few years to bolster economic growth and development. The provisions of the Budget indicate the continuation of the government's strategic approach toward economic expansion, fiscal prudence, and sectoral growth. One of announcements in the Budget that has been most widely welcomed is the significant cut in personal income-tax, with complete exemption extended to individuals earning up to ₹12 lakh per year. This limit will be ₹12.75 lakh for salaried tax-payers because of the standard deduction of ₹75,000. This is a major relief for the middle class, and is expected to have a multiplier effect on the economy. Higher disposable income can trigger a virtuous cycle of higher consumption, increased demand, and improved business performance. This, in turn, will result in higher indirect tax collections and further economic expansion. Specifically, greater consumer spending will benefit industries such as retail, real estate, and automobile manufacturing, boosting employment opportunities.

Another key highlight of the Budget is the allocation of ₹11.2 lakh crore for capital expenditure for 2025-26, marking an increase of nearly 10% from the actual expenditure in the current fiscal year. This enhanced spending can drive infrastructure development, boost employment generation, and catalyse economic activity across sectors. And, of course, it strengthens the nation's logistical and industrial backbone, ensuring long-term sustainable growth. In a major thrust to manufacturing, the Finance Minister, Nirmala Sitharaman, has also announced the establishment of a National Manufacturing Mission. The aim is to promote the 'Make in India' initiative by covering small, medium, and large industries, providing policy support, execution road maps, and governance frameworks in collaboration with central Ministries and States. The mission is expected to enhance domestic capabilities, reduce import dependency, and encourage foreign investment. While the finer details are yet to be examined, it appears to be a well-conceived initiative.

By streamlining regulatory processes, offering incentives, and creating an enabling business environment, this initiative has the potential to position India as a global manufacturing hub. In consonance with the government's commitment to job creation, the Budget is focused on labour-intensive sectors such as tourism, food processing and leather. These industries have historically been major employment generators and contribute substantially to India's export earnings. By providing targeted incentives and streamlining regulations, the Budget aims to enhance productivity, improve competitiveness, and create new job opportunities in these sectors. On the infrastructure side, we see the Budget focus on the maritime sector through the announcement of a new Maritime Development Fund. This will give a boost to the marine economy, especially in the coastal States of the country, creating growth opportunities for both trade and the blue economy-related segments.

Part for Skimming

The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) has also noted with interest the plan for flight connectivity to 120 new destinations under a modified Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik (UDAN) scheme as this too will enable new economic opportunities in newly connected regions of the country as emerging growth centres. The Budget has introduced the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana, a targeted initiative designed to enhance agricultural productivity and improve rural livelihoods. The programme will cover 100 districts with low productivity, moderate crop intensity, and below-average credit access, in partnership with State governments. This initiative aims to promote crop diversification and sustainable agricultural practices, enhance post-harvest storage infrastructure, improve irrigation facilities, and facilitate access to credit.

With an estimated 1.7 crore farmer-beneficiaries, this has the potential to transform the agricultural landscape, increase rural incomes, and drive economic activity in India's hinterlands. Higher rural purchasing power will indirectly benefit the corporate sector, particularly those involved in consumer goods and agricultural supply chains. Another commendable aspect of the Budget is the government's resolve to reduce the fiscal deficit from 4.8% in 2024-25 to 4.4% in 2025-26. This move is critical as sound public finance management is a sine qua non for sustained economic growth. A lower fiscal deficit will help stabilise inflation, increase investor confidence, and create a more robust macroeconomic environment. Rationalisation of the duty structure and simplification of the tariff framework by removing an additional seven tariff rates is a noteworthy announcement. While this may sound simple, it is a major step towards simplification and enhancing ease of doing business for industry.

The rationalisation of cess by ensuring that no more than one cess or surcharge would be levied is a crucial step toward ensuring a fairer and more predictable taxation regime, benefiting both industry and consumers. The Budget has also addressed the issue of inverted duty structure for some products, which is a welcome step. This would enhance trade competitiveness and encourage greater participation of domestic firms in global supply chains. The continued focus on capital expenditure, manufacturing, and labour-intensive sectors, combined with fiscal prudence and income-tax relief, sets the stage for robust growth in the years ahead. While the finer details of various schemes and policies will need closer examination, the overarching framework of the Budget suggests a proactive, forward-looking, and growth-oriented strategy. As businesses and stakeholders begin to analyse and adapt to the new measures, the true impact of Budget 2025-26 will unfold in the next few months.

Summary

The Union Budget 2025-26 emphasizes economic growth, fiscal prudence, and sectoral development. Key highlights include a significant cut in personal income tax, increased capital expenditure, and initiatives to boost manufacturing, infrastructure, and job creation. The National Manufacturing Mission and sectoral incentives aim to strengthen India's industrial and export capabilities. The Budget also focuses on agriculture through the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana, and infrastructure development, including maritime and air connectivity. Additionally, measures to reduce the fiscal deficit and simplify tax structures reinforce economic stability. The overall strategy reflects a forward-looking approach to sustained growth.

The tone of the passage is optimistic, analytical, and appreciative. It highlights the positive impact of the Budget while acknowledging the need for further examination of specific policy details.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Which of the following is a direct economic effect expected from the increase in the income-tax exemption limit?

a) A decrease in tax revenue leading to higher fiscal deficit
b) An increase in consumer spending, leading to higher demand in various industries
c) A decline in savings as people will spend more on discretionary expenses
d) An increase in corporate tax rates to compensate for the revenue loss
e) None of the above

Question 2
What is the primary objective of the National Manufacturing Mission announced in the Budget?

a) To privatize major manufacturing industries in India
b) To increase government intervention in industrial policy and regulate businesses more closely
c) To promote domestic manufacturing by providing policy support, incentives, and an enabling business environment
d) To encourage Indian companies to expand their manufacturing operations abroad
e) None of the above

Question 3
Why is the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana considered significant for India's agaricultural sector?

a) It focuses on developing urban agriculture and rooftop farming initiatives.
b) It aims to provide direct financial assistance to farmers without any other structural reforms.
c) It covers districts with low productivity and credit access to improve agricultural infrastructure and rural livelihoods.
d) It replaces all existing agricultural schemes with a single, unified program.
e) None of the above

Question 4
What is the rationale behind the government's focus on the maritime sector in this Budget?

a) To develop new cruise tourism hubs in India’s coastal states
b) To enhance trade and blue economy-related growth opportunities through a Maritime Development Fund
c) To introduce stricter environmental regulations on shipping companies
d) To reduce India's dependency on international shipping routes by investing in domestic shipbuilding
e) None of the above

Question 5
Why is the rationalisation of the duty structure and tariff framework considered significant?

a) It helps domestic industries by addressing the inverted duty structure and enhancing trade competitiveness.
b) It makes tax regulations more complex, requiring businesses to comply with multiple tariff rates.
c) It allows multiple cesses and surcharges to be imposed for higher revenue generation.
d) It exclusively benefits the manufacturing sector without any impact on trade.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question

Original Text:

The emergence of AI tools like ChatGPT has significantly impacted journalism, transforming how news is produced, distributed, and consumed. These AI-driven tools enhance efficiency by assisting journalists in content creation, fact-checking, and data analysis. However, they also raise concerns about misinformation, job displacement, and ethical implications in news reporting. One of the most notable benefits of ChatGPT in journalism is speed and efficiency. AI can generate reports, summarize articles, and analyze vast amounts of data within seconds, allowing journalists to focus on investigative work and in-depth reporting.

ChatGPT can also assist in fact-checking, identifying inconsistencies in news stories, and providing multilingual translations to make news accessible to a broader audience.However, AI-driven journalism comes with risks. ChatGPT lacks human judgment and contextual understanding, sometimes generating inaccurate or biased content. The spread of AI-generated misinformation or deepfakes can undermine public trust in the media. Additionally, as AI takes over routine reporting tasks, concerns about job losses in journalism arise, potentially reducing employment opportunities in traditional newsrooms. Despite these challenges, AI and journalism can coexist productively. News organizations must establish ethical guidelines for AI use, ensuring human oversight in news production. Combining AI's efficiency with human editorial judgment can improve journalism's quality, making news more accurate, accessible, and engaging.

Precis:

ChatGPT has transformed journalism by enhancing efficiency in content creation, fact-checking, and data analysis. It allows journalists to focus on investigative work while making news more accessible. However, risks like misinformation, bias, and job displacement remain concerns.

To balance AI's benefits and challenges, human oversight and ethical guidelines are essential. Combining AI’s speed with human judgment can improve journalism’s accuracy and reliability while preserving its integrity.

- **Write an email to the customer service department of a company to lodge a formal complaint about the poor quality of their product or service.**

To: …….@gmail.com

Subject: Formal Complaint Regarding Poor Quality of [Product/Service]

Dear Customer Service Team,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to formally lodge a complaint regarding the poor quality of [product/service] that I recently purchased/experienced from your company.

On [purchase date/service date], I bought/used [product/service name] from [store/website/location]. Unfortunately, I was extremely disappointed with its quality/performance. [Briefly describe the issue, e.g., “The product stopped working within a few days,” or “The service provided was unsatisfactory due to delays/errors.”]

This has caused significant inconvenience, and I believe it does not meet the quality standards expected from your brand.

I have attached relevant documents, including the receipt, photographs, and any communication related to this issue, for your reference. I request an immediate resolution, either through a replacement, refund, or appropriate corrective action.

Looking forward to your swift resolution. You may contact me at [your phone number] or [your email address] for further discussion.

Best regards,
[Your Full Name]
[Your Contact Information]
[Your Address (if required)]

Match the column

1. Fair-weather friend
2. Food for thought
3. In ages
4. Scare the living daylights out of
5. A bone to pick

A. Something that makes you think deeply
B. Someone who is only a friend in good times
C. To frighten someone very badly
D. An issue that needs to be discussed
E. For a very long time

Answer:

1-b

2-a

3-e

4-c

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Bolster:
2. Virtuous Cycle:
3. Catalyse:
4. Consonance:
5. Sine Qua Non:
6. Bumps:
7. Demoting:
8. Acrimonious:
9. Skeptical:
10. Revamp:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

Reference: "Higher disposable income can trigger a virtuous cycle of higher consumption, increased demand, and improved business performance. This, in turn, will result in higher indirect tax collections and further economic expansion."

The passage states that higher disposable income will result in increased consumption, leading to greater demand in industries such as retail, real estate, and automobiles, which in turn boosts economic growth.

Incorrect Options:

a) While tax revenue may decrease in the short term, the passage suggests higher indirect tax collections due to increased consumption, which may offset the loss.

c) The passage does not state that savings will decline; rather, it focuses on the multiplier effect of spending.

d) There is no mention of corporate tax rate increases to compensate for revenue loss.

2.
Ans: c
Explanation:
Reference: "The aim is to promote the ‘Make in India’ initiative by covering small, medium, and large industries, providing policy support, execution road maps, and governance frameworks."

The passage highlights that the National Manufacturing Mission aims to promote domestic industries by offering policy support, execution road maps, and governance frameworks. It aligns with the ‘Make in India’ initiative to reduce import dependency and attract foreign investment.

Incorrect Options:

a) There is no mention of privatization of manufacturing industries.
b) The passage suggests the opposite, emphasizing deregulation rather than increased government control.
d) The mission aims to boost domestic manufacturing, not encourage expansion abroad.

3.
Ans: c
Explanation:
Reference: "The programme will cover 100 districts with low productivity, moderate crop intensity, and below-average credit access, in partnership with State governments."

The passage states that the scheme targets 100 districts with low productivity, moderate crop intensity, and below-average credit access. It seeks to promote crop diversification, improve irrigation, enhance storage, and facilitate access to credit, thereby improving rural incomes and economic activity.

Incorrect Options:

a) The scheme focuses on rural farming rather than urban agriculture or rooftop farming.
b) The initiative goes beyond financial assistance and includes infrastructure development and sustainability measures.
d) There is no mention of replacing all existing agricultural schemes.

4.
Ans: b
Explanation:
Reference: "The Budget focus on the maritime sector through the announcement of a new Maritime Development Fund. This will give a boost to the marine economy, especially in the coastal States."

The passage mentions that the Budget has announced a Maritime Development Fund, which is expected to boost the marine economy, particularly in coastal states. This initiative is aimed at creating growth opportunities for trade and blue economy-related sectors.

Incorrect Options:

a) There is no mention of cruise tourism hubs in the passage.
c) The passage does not mention stricter environmental regulations as the focus of this initiative.
d) While the initiative aims to boost maritime growth, there is no specific reference to reducing reliance on international routes.

5.

Ans: a

Explanation:

Reference: "The rationalisation of cess by ensuring that no more than one cess or surcharge would be levied is a crucial step toward ensuring a fairer and more predictable taxation regime, benefiting both industry and consumers."

The passage highlights that simplifying tariffs and rationalizing duties will eliminate distortions in trade, making Indian businesses more competitive globally. Addressing the inverted duty structure is a key step in ensuring fairer trade policies for domestic industries.

Incorrect Options:

b) The passage states the opposite—it makes taxation simpler rather than more complex.
c) The Budget aims to reduce the number of cesses and surcharges, not increase them.
d) While the manufacturing sector benefits, the impact extends to trade competitiveness as well.

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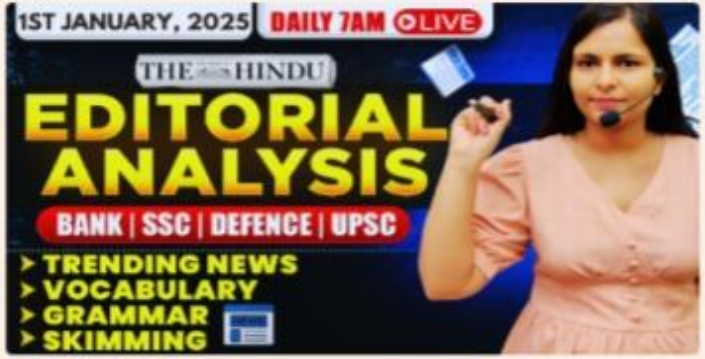

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